

Payment Gateway Timeout Recurrence - CNA Connection Pool

Meridian Commercial Bank - Internal Document

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Summary

On 2026-05-11, the Payments Gateway (PGW) experienced a second connection pool exhaustion incident against the Card Network Adapter (CNA) service, closely resembling INC-2025-08-14-001 from nine months earlier. Approximately 11% of card-present authorizations timed out over a 40-minute window.

Timeline

- 15:20 - PGW p99 latency alert fires.
- 15:24 - On-call recognizes the pattern from INC-2025-08-14-001 and checks CNA connection pool configuration first, per the updated runbook.
- 15:27 - Confirms CNA connection pool size was reduced to 10 again, this time due to a configuration management tool reverting to a stale template during an unrelated infrastructure-as-code refactor.
- 15:35 - Connection pool size corrected and CNA redeployed.
- 16:00 - Latency fully recovered.

Root Cause

The CNA connection pool size (200) had been set as a manual override outside the standard infrastructure-as-code (IaC) templates after INC-2025-08-14-001. An unrelated IaC refactor in April 2026 consolidated service configs into a shared template, which did not carry forward the manual override, silently resetting the pool size to the framework default of 10 on the next deploy.

Impact

- Approximately 11% of card-present authorizations failed for 40 minutes.
- Estimated 1,900 declined-in-error transactions.
- Detected and resolved faster than the original incident (40 min vs 95 min) due to the runbook update from the 2025-08-14 action items.

Resolution

- Corrected CNA connection pool size and redeployed.
- Added the connection pool size as a required, tested field in the CNA IaC module rather than a manual override.

Action Items

1. Convert all "manual override" post-incident fixes into first-class, tested IaC configuration rather than out-of-band changes (Owner: Platform Engineering, Due: 2026-05-25).
2. Add a config-drift detection job that diffs live service configuration against the last known-good incident-remediation baseline (Owner: SRE,

Due: 2026-06-15).

Related Incidents

Direct recurrence of INC-2025-08-14-001. Root cause category: configuration drift undoing a prior incident remediation. This is a distinct systemic issue from the capacity-planning theme in INC-2025-10-02-002 and INC-2025-12-19-003, and warrants its own action-item tracking separate from capacity/scaling fixes.